

August

19



1934

Soap Box Derby

The first All-American Soap Box Derby was held in Dayton, USA, with children driving homemade cars propelled only by gravity. First down the hill to become championship winner was 11-year-old Robert Turner, in a wooden vehicle running on buggy wheels.

Also on this day

1839 French photographer **Louis Daguerre** showcased his invention of daguerreotypes – camera images produced by chemical reactions on silver plates.

1887 Russian chemist **Dmitri Mendeleev** flew solo in a hot-air balloon to watch a solar eclipse in the skies over Russia.

1931 Water levels reached a height of 16 m (53 ft) during devastating floods in China, which affected millions.

Olympic cricket

The only cricket match played at the Olympics took place at the Vélodrome de Vincennes stadium in Paris, France. Great Britain beat France by 158 runs.

1900

Born this day

1883 **Coco Chanel**, French fashion designer. She founded the Chanel brand, and is famous for her designs of handbags, perfumes, and clothing, including the “little black dress”.

Harris for vice president

Following a successful career as a lawyer and politician, Kamala Harris accepted the nomination for vice president (VP) of the USA, becoming the first woman of colour from a major party to be a candidate. She went on to become the country's first female VP.

2020

